dium, with some images printed in Germany for Indian markets. The inclusion of painted works and portable triptych shrines enriches this narrative, pointing to an ongoing dialogue between artisanal and mechanical forms of image-making.

The rise of these prints coincided with cultural and political change in India. As the early stirrings of the independence movement took hold, such images quietly expressed religious and national identity.

DIETIES WERE REPRESENTED IN ACCESSIBLE AND STANDARDISED FORMS, SHAPING A SHARED VISUAL LANGUAGE ACROSS REGIONS

Displayed in four rotations, the exhibition also includes paintings and portable shrines, presenting a broader continuum of devotional practice. Together, they reveal a moment when technological innovation reshaped religious experience, making the divine more immediate. ■

—Nikhil Sardana

The exhibition is on till Jun. 27, 2027

EXHIBITION ▼

Change Is the Only Constant

ARTIST AKANKSHA PATIL DOCUMENTS A MAHARASTHRA VILLAGE DISPLACED BY DEVELOPMENT

Exploring themes of migration, identity, belonging and displacement, a new solo exhibition in the capital provides a poignant perspective on development and its human cost. Artist Akanksha Patil engages with Shivangaon, a village in Maharashtra impacted by the expansion of Nagpur airport. She spent two and a half years documenting every fragment of Shivangaon, deeply affected by the realities of urban expansion and forced migration, capturing its shift from a village to a demolition site. "Incorporating corrugated sheets, cardboard, ceramic, wood, cloth, bricks, cement, found materials, everyday objects and video projection, I present the community's voices and loss," she says.





Patil's practice is deeply rooted in the idea of 'saudade'—a Portuguese term expressing the melancholic longing for a home left behind. The works investigate displacement, urban expansion and the erosion of cultural practices. Incorporating drawings made by local children alongside photographs and maps, it forms an intimate archive of memory and place. "Patil's practice is both personal and political. Drawing from lived experiences, she creates narratives that reflect broader sociocultural transformations," adds curator Georgina Maddox. ■

—Neha Kirpal

The exhibition is on at Gallery Art Positive, New Delhi, till Apr. 27

CORRUGATED PATH 'Common Ground of Longing' by (inset) Akanksha Patil

His wife Rama's cotton sari, worn when she first met him, his letters, manuscripts, family portraits are all on display

the archive of his grandfather Bibhutibhushan Bandyopadhay's writings, letters and other possessions.

His wife Rama's pale-blue cotton sari with a golden zari border, worn when she went to meet him (then already a famous author) for the first time, his letters to her that show the salutation evolving from a formal "kalyaniashu" (auspicious one) to "priyotomashu" (beloved), family portraits, novel outlines, train tickets, pens and even the original manuscript and rare editions of his novels take one through the writer's life. The exhibit ends with Trinankur's rendition of Bibhutibhushan's favourite flowers like palash, shaluk, madar, etc. He was "deeply connected with nature and did not value cultivated or ornamental beauty, but was drawn to wild, roadside flowers, giving them prominence in his writing", says Trinankur.

Another motif of the author was "*goti jibon, gotir doinyo mrityu* (movement is life, stagnation is death)". Who would know this better than the writer of 'Song of the Road', Bibhutibhushan Bandyopadhyay? ■

—Malini Banerjee

God of the Little Road/ Pather Debota is on till Apr. 19